



# Getting a good night's sleep

How Neend is helping Indians sleep better at night

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**I**ndia is the second most sleep-deprived country where 30 per cent of the population is occasionally insomniac and almost 20% is regularly insomniac, according to Surbhi Jain. "The sleep-aid market is a \$10 billion opportunity, and its surface hasn't even been scratched yet," she says.

Hailing from Lawa, a small town in Rajasthan, Surbhi Jain is the founder of Neend, a Bangalore-based startup

that helps solve people's sleep-related problems through a health and wellness app on your smartphone. Neend offers stories, sleep sounds, guided meditation and other calming and relaxing audio experiences in several Indian regional languages. An IIT-Bombay alumnus with over eight years of startup ecosystem experience, Jain says she came up with Neend after having to deal with her own sleep-related issues caused during the COVID-19 pandemic.

"Neend was conceptualized when I myself faced sleep issues at the peak of the pandemic and all the stresses that came with it. After some research, I found out that India is the second most sleep deprived country in the world," says Surbhi Jain.

Sleep-related issues are often linked with physical ailments like low immunity, poor cardiovascular health, memory loss and eating disorders, according to Jain. Not just that but sleep is also linked to mental well-being, lack of which can cause emotional disorders, anxiety, depression or loss of motivation.

Jain claims that despite the high demand for sleep remedies, there weren't enough non-medical solutions for cure or relief. "Especially for the population that does not speak English," according to Jain. "Hence I launched Neend to address this pain point and started off with the content vertical."

In over a year, Neend developed over 1000 sleep stories in five languages. Surbhi Jain recounts how the content was initially hosted on just YouTube as a pilot and within just three months of encouraging tracking, the Neend app was launched across Android and iOS – the Android app now has over 5 lakh downloads. The biggest differentiator for our content has been that it is available in vernacular languages (Hindi, Marathi, Tamil, Telugu) and is in sync with the local Indian context in addition to the English content.

While true for many industries, the one thing that stands out very prominently for the health and wellness industry is the need for personalization. Since every individual has their own meaning of what wellness means to them, solutions must also cater to this diversity, and Surbhi Jain and Neend's team understand this differentiator very well. "We are solving this need by pursuing localization in our content," she emphasizes.

The Neend app does this by giving the listener an overwhelming sense of familiarity, from the sounds to content,